Product Specification – Conventional Cacao Powder

1. Product Information:

Item	Description
Product Name	BULK Conventional Cacao Powder
Product Code	**SUFL7444**
Botanical Name	Theobroma Cacao
Country of Origin	Sierra Leone
Brief Description	Our Alkalized Cocoa Powder is made from premium-quality cocoa beans (Theobroma cacao) that are roasted, broken, and de-shelled before being ground into cocoa liquor. This liquor is then hydraulically pressed to extract the cocoa butter, leaving behind a press cake that is finely milled into a smooth powder. Alkalization is carried out on either the nibs or the liquor to enhance the powder's color, taste, and solubility. The final product, containing 2.5% potassium carbonate, features a rich dark brown hue. Try adding our cocoa powder to baked goods, hot chocolate blends, smoothies, or protein shakes for a deep, chocolatey flavor and a smooth, well-balanced finish.
Ingredients	100% Cacao Beans (2.5% Potassium carbonate used for Alkalization)
Intended Use	Bulk Ingredient
Packaging/Net Weight	LDPE bag with Brown Paper Bag 25kg
Shelf Life & Storage	24 months from the manufacture date under suitable storage conditions. It should be stored under suitable conditions in a cool and dry place. Keep the cacao powder far from direct sunlight.

2. Nutritional Properties:

Nutrition	Per 100g
Energy	1289 kJ / 308 kcal
Fat	11 g
Of which saturates	6.5 g
Carbohydrate	11.9 g
Of which sugars	0 g
Fibre	31.1 g
Protein	21 g
Salt	0.3 g

The nutritional information provided in this document is based on nutritional testing and on average, as required by regulation (EC) No 1169/2011.

3. Organoleptic Properties:

Criteria	Description
Appearance/Texture	Fine Powder
Flavour	Characteristics
Aroma	Characteristics
Colour	Dark brown

4. Physical & Chemical Characteristics:

Criteria	Description
Particle size	75 **(µm)**
Foreign Materials	<0.05%
Moisture	4.5%. Max.
Ash	10% Max
pH	7.0-7.6

5. Microbiological Characteristics:

Criteria	Value
Plate Count	≤100000 cfu/g
Yeast	≤1000 cfu/g
Mold	≤1000 cfu/g
E. Coli	Not Detected cfu/g
Salmonella	Not Detected /25g
Bacillus Cereus	≤10000 cfu/g
Listeria	Not Detected c25g
Clostridium Perfringens	≤1000 cfu/g
Staphylococcus Aureus	≤100 cfu/g
Enterobacteriaceae	≤1000 cfu/g

6. Dietary information:

Diet	Suitable For	Certified	Comments
Organic	No		
Vegetarian	Yes	Yes	
Vegan	Yes	Yes	
Jewish / Kosher	Yes	Yes	
Muslim / Halal	Yes	No	Suitable but not certified

7. Allergen Information:

Allergen Component	Present (as an Ingredient)	Absent as Ingredient (on same Line)	Present in Processing Plant	Source of Allergen
Celery & product there	No	No	No	-
Cereals Containing Gluten	No	No	No	-
Crustaceans	No	No	No	-
Eggs	No	No	No	-
Fish	No	No	No	-
Lupin	No	No	No	-
Milk	No	No	No	-
Molluscs	No	No	No	-
Mustard	No	No	No	-
Nuts	No	No	No	-
Peanuts	No	No	No	-
Sesame Seeds	No	No	No	-
Soybeans	No	No	No	-
Sulphur Dioxide & Sulphites	No	No	No	-
Comments:	Complete segregation in place *Nuts include Almond, Beach nut, Brazil nut, Butternut, California walnut, Cashew, Chestnut (Chinese, American, European, Seguin), Chinquapin, Cashews, Coconut, Cola nut/Kola nut, Filbert/hazelnut, Ginko nut, Heartnut/Japanese walnut, Hickory nut, Macadamia nut/Bust nut, Palm nut, Pecan nut, Pecan, Pine nut/Pinon nut, Pili nut, Pistachio, Shea nut, Walnut (English, Persian)			

8. Contaminants:

Parameters	Limits
Heavy Metals (lead, cadmium, mercury, tin, arsenic)	According to Regulation (EC) No 915/2023
Mycotoxins (aflatoxins, ochratoxins A,)	According to Regulation (EC) No 915/2023
Polycyclic Aromatic Hydrocarbons (PAH)	According to Regulation (EC) No 915/2023

9. Quality, Regulatory & Brand Integrity Compliance:

Category	Compliance Criteria	Yes/No / N/A
Good Manufacturing Standards	The packaging meets hygiene and traceability requirements Regulation (EC) No. 2023/2006 on good manufacturing practice. FCMs should be manufactured in compliance with general and detailed rules on good manufacturing practice (GMP). Quality assurance system, quality control system, and documentation system is established, implemented, and maintained..	Yes
	The packaging supplier is GFSI certified to demonstrate GMP in the manufacturing process	No
Paper & board	The packaging is chlorine free (TCF) or elemental chlorine free (ECF)	N/A
	Photo initiators –including benzophenone (4 methyl benzophenone) are not used	N/A
	Acrylamide is not used in printers and board mills	N/A
Printed Packaging	low odor and migration inks and varnishes to ensure migration legislative limits on benzophenone and its derivatives are met	N/A
	ITX is not used as a photo initiator in printed inks	N/A
Packaging chemical migration test	Migration tests for packaging materials available.	Yes
	The packaging migration test include all legislatives chemical and Tinuvin UV absorber, phthalates and monomers – SVHCs Phthalates in plastic foils and bags	Yes
Non-intentionally added substances (NIAS)	The packaging is free from impurities that may be non-intentionally added to food contact packaging material including substances such as contaminants, reaction and degradation products	Yes
Nano Particles	The packaging does not contain or consist of engineered nanoparticles	Yes
PVC & PVCD	The plastic material is free from PVC	Yes
Mineral Oil Hydrocarbons	Migration of Mineral Oil Hydrocarbons (MOH), must meet German MOSH Benchmark Levels (send test report) and EU limits on MOAH	Yes
Chemical substance of very high concern (SVHC)	The packaging does not contain or use acrylamides, novolac glycidyl ethers, perfluoro octane sulphonate, phthalates, NOGE, PFOS & PFOAS, PVC and Derivatives, Semi carbazides, 4-methylbenzophenone	Yes
Additives	The material complies with EU food contact material legislation and does not contain dual additives chemicals e.g., Phosphoric Acid or Sulphur Dioxide	Yes
Recycled plastics	Comply with New Regulation (EU) 2022/16161 on recycled plastic materials and articles intended to come into contact with foods.	N/A
Metalized & rubber packaging e.g. foil bags	Packaging material does not contain Bisphenol and meet the limits Bisphenol A (BPA) BADGE, BFDGE, NODGE	Yes
Compostable packaging	The compostable/biodegradable packaging complies with European Standard for Compostable Packaging (EN13432)	N/A

The packaging is in accordance with the EU Legislation:
• Council Directive on Packaging and Packaging Waste 94/62/EC and its consecutive amendments.
• Commission Regulation (EC) No 1935/2004 on Materials and Articles Intended to Come into Contact with Food and its consecutive amendments.
• Commission Regulation (EU) No 10/2011 on Plastic Materials and Articles Intended to Come into Contact with Food and its consecutive amendments.

10. GMO Free:

This product is not subject to genetic modifications. Process controls are in place to ensure no accidental contamination with genetically modified materials, or materials derived thereafter, can occur. We hereby certify that this product is not subject to labeling under EU Regulations 1829/2003/EC and 1830/2003/EC on genetically modified food and feed.

11. WADA Statement:

We declare that our products do not contain any of the substances mentioned in the Yearly updated “Prohibited List” from the World Anti

12. Irradiation and Ethylene Oxide:

We declare that the product listed above is not treated with ionizing radiation (r2) or ethylene oxide (EtO) for any purposes and as such are free of gamma ray and ethylene oxide residue and complies with the EU regulation 1999/3/EC

13. **BSE Statement:**

This product is manufactured exclusively from plant source, and does not contain any components from animal origin. It has not been derived from any animal source, and has not come into contact with any components of animal origin.

14. **Residual Solvents:**

No residual solvents are used in the manufacturing process.

15. **Level of Undesirable Substances:**

The strictly controlled production process of this product ensures that the undesirable substances levels (heavy metals, PAH, mycotoxins, etc.) are below the limits identified by EU legislation (No 2023/915 on maximum levels for certain contaminants in food and consecutive amendments, Commission Regulation No 2073/2005, including the recommendations provided by EFSA on food contaminants.

16. **Animal Testing Statement:**

Sahara UK Foods Ltd confirms that we do not conduct or commission animal testing of any products.

17. **Endangered Species of Fauna and Flora:**

None of our products are listed as banned on the world Convention on International Trade of Endangered Species of Fauna and Flora (CITES).

18. **Novel Foods:**

This product complies with the Regulation (EU) 2015/2283 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 25 November 2015 on novel foods, amending Regulation (EU) No 1169/2011 of the European Parliament and of the Council and repealing Regulation (EC) No 258/97 of the European Parliament and of the Council and Commission Regulation (EC) No 1852/2001.

19. Additional information:

This Product is 100% Natural and Organic; it is not considered hazardous.

The information in this document is believed to be true and accurate at the time of creation, however all statements contained in this document are made without warranty. The entirety of the potential methods of use is not within our control and therefore no responsibility or liability will be assumed for use of this product.
The information contained herein is based on the present state of our knowledge and is intended to describe our product from the point of safety requirements. Therefore, it should not be construed as guaranteed specific properties of the product described. Our product specification may be subject to change without notice.
This is an agricultural product; therefore, some batch variation may occur in terms of colour, flavour, odour, appearance and composition based on the growing conditions and seasonal variability.
The nutritional information provided in this document is based on nutritional testing and on average, as required by regulation (EC) No 1169/2011. The information is not meant to ensure warranty of characteristics. It comes without commitment and is not valid for any claim of warranty and product liability respectively.

Agreement of Specification – If no signed copy of this specification is received within 28 days of issue to the Customer then this will be considered accepted.			
Supplier Name	Sahara UK Foods Ltd	**Customer Name**	
Name	Nazia Shamim	**Name**	
Signature (on behalf of SFUL)	*NS*	**Signature (on behalf of Customer)**	
Position	Technical & QA Manager	**Position**	
Date	24/06/2025	**Date**	